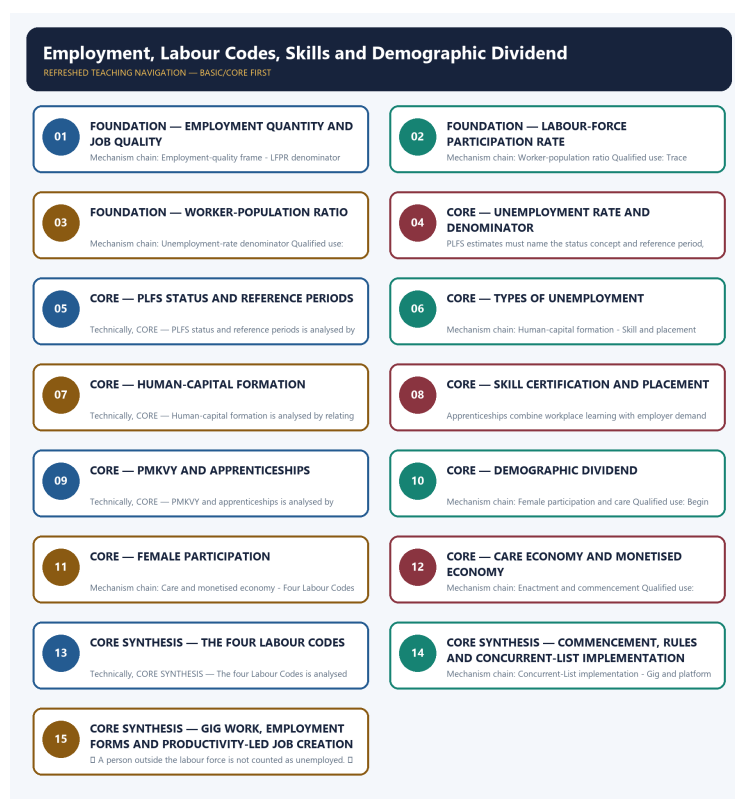


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Employment, Labour Codes, Skills and Demographic Dividend - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Employment, Labour Codes, Skills and Demographic Dividend - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-03. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-03.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. OCR-searchable local official General Studies papers were used only to confirm printed routed demands. No answer key, marking scheme, unsupported page precision or current macroeconomic statistic was inferred from them.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Audited ledgers route Mains demands on productivity-led job creation, structural-unemployment measurement, the care economy, Labour Codes, inflation and unemployment, and skill-to-employment linkages, plus objective concepts on human capital, PMKVY, fixed-term work, casual workers and industrial-dispute statistics. No objective key is inferred.
- **Live-link boundary:** Official Ministry search results support commencement on 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026. Direct pages and the annual-report PDF returned HTTP 403, so no state-by-state rule count, employment value, scheme target or outlay was added.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

The checks below were made on 2026-09-03. Substantive official text is used only for the proposition it actually supports; binary files, dynamic shells, stubs and undated dashboard snippets are recorded but not converted into current claims.

- <https://labour.gov.in/offerings/schemes-and-services/details/labour-codes-gzNzQzMtQWa> - direct fetch returned HTTP 403 on 2026-09-03; official-domain search substantively exposed commencement and Central-Rules milestones.
- <https://www.labour.gov.in/documents/acts-and-policies> - official-domain search identified the Ministry's current Labour Codes and rules pages; jurisdiction-specific state readiness was not fully retrievable.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Economy Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Formula boundary	Formula, numerator, denominator, unit, stock/flow, nominal/real, base year, level/rate and accounting identity are explicit.
Institutional boundary	Constitution, statute, delegated rule, regulator mandate, policy, recommendation, scheme and implementation outcome remain distinct.
Transmission method	Shock or instrument -> prices/quantities/balance sheets/incentives -> institution and market response -> output, employment, distribution, stability and external effect -> lag and trade-off.
Current-data method	Source -> release date -> reference period -> unit/denominator -> provisional/revised/final status; incompatible Budget, Survey or statistical vintages are never mixed.
Programme-status method	Announced -> approved -> notified/guidelines issued -> funded -> operational -> utilised -> output -> outcome are separate stages.
External/WTO method	Agreement text, member category, box, limit, notification, consultation, dispute and ruling are qualified without invented thresholds.
Causal method	Accounting identity, chronology and correlation are not promoted into behavioural or causal claims without mechanism, counterfactual and alternatives.
Answer balance	Model answers balance growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal dimensions with India-centric evidence.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Economy\basic\22_Employment-Labour-Codes-Skills-and-Demographic-Dividend.md **Substantive canonical provenance owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Economy\22_Employment-Labour-Codes-Skills-and-Demographic-Dividend_Learner-V2-Complete-Topic-Package.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Economy\advanced\22_Employment-Labour-Codes-Skills-and-Demographic-Dividend.md **Official syllabus mapping:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Economy\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- Every data-heavy table states unit, denominator, geography, reference period and source/status.
- GDP/GVA, gross/net, domestic/national, nominal/real and level/rate distinctions remain exact.
- Monetary, fiscal and external chains state intermediaries, balance-sheet channels, lags, leakages and trade-offs.
- Budget and Economic Survey editions are never mixed; BE, RE, Actual, advance/provisional/revised/final estimates remain labelled.
- Scheme and programme claims distinguish announcement, approval, notification, operation, coverage, utilisation and measured outcome.
- WTO boxes, limits, de minimis, special treatment, notifications and disputes are qualified from authoritative rules.
- PYQ wording is preserved only where verified; reconstructed or routed demands remain labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-06:** volatile rates, estimates, scheme status, trade rules and institutional claims retain official source, release date, reference period and revision status.

Generation-local live/current sources:

- <https://labour.gov.in/offerings/schemes-and-services/details/labour-codes-gzNzQzMtQW> a - direct fetch returned HTTP 403 on 2026-09-03; official-domain search substantively exposed commencement and Central-Rules milestones.
- <https://www.labour.gov.in/documents/acts-and-policies> - official-domain search identified the Ministry's current Labour Codes and rules pages; jurisdiction-specific state readiness was not fully retrievable.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - Employment quantity and job quality

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Employment quantity and job quality explains how Employment-quality frame and LFPR denominator fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Employment quantity and job quality separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Employment quantity and job quality must be read through Employment-quality frame and LFPR denominator, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Employment
- quantity
- quality
- Employment-quality
- frame
- LFPR

How to use them: Define Employment, quantity, quality; attach Employment-quality to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not use total population as the unemployment-rate denominator.

VISUAL FIRST

EMPLOYMENT QUANTITY AND JOB QUALITY

01. Employment-quality frame

|

v

02. LFPR denominator

BOUNDARY -> Do not use total population as the unemployment-rate denominator.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.
- The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not use total population as the unemployment-rate denominator.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Employment-quality frame -> LFPR denominator
- **Qualified use:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Employment quantity quality Employment-quality frame LFPR	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Employment-quality frame and LFPR denominator through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not use total population as the unemployment-rate denominator.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Employment quantity and job quality converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - Labour-force participation rate

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Labour-force participation rate explains how Worker-population ratio fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Labour-force participation rate separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Labour-force participation rate must be read through Worker-population ratio, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Labour-force
- participation
- rate
- Worker-population
- ratio
- employed

How to use them: Define Labour-force, participation, rate; attach Worker-population to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not treat people outside the labour force as unemployed.

VISUAL FIRST

LABOUR-FORCE PARTICIPATION RATE

01. Worker-population ratio

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat people outside the labour force as unemployed.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat people outside the labour force as unemployed.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Worker-population ratio
- **Qualified use:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Labour-force participation rate Worker-population ratio employed	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Worker-population ratio through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not treat people outside the labour force as unemployed.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Labour-force participation rate converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - Worker-population ratio

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Worker-population ratio explains how Unemployment-rate denominator fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Worker-population ratio separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Worker-population ratio must be read through Unemployment-rate denominator, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Worker-population
- ratio
- Unemployment-rate

- denominator
- unemployment
- rate

How to use them: Define Worker-population, ratio, Unemployment-rate; attach denominator to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not quote PLFS data without status, reference period, age group and geography.

VISUAL FIRST

WORKER-POPULATION RATIO

01. Unemployment-rate denominator

BOUNDARY -> Do not quote PLFS data without status, reference period, age group and geography.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not quote PLFS data without status, reference period, age group and geography.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Unemployment-rate denominator
- **Qualified use:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Worker-population ratio Unemployment-rate denominator unemployment rate	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Unemployment-rate denominator through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not quote PLFS data without status, reference period, age group and geography.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Worker-population ratio converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 4 - CORE - Unemployment rate and denominator

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Unemployment rate and denominator explains how PLFS status and reference period fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Unemployment rate and denominator separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Unemployment rate and denominator must be read through PLFS status and reference period, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Unemployment
- rate
- denominator
- PLFS
- status
- reference

How to use them: Define Unemployment, rate, denominator; attach PLFS to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not infer job quality from an employment headcount.

VISUAL FIRST

UNEMPLOYMENT RATE AND DENOMINATOR

01. PLFS status and reference period

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer job quality from an employment headcount.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer job quality from an employment headcount.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** PLFS status and reference period
- **Qualified use:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Unemployment rate denominator PLFS status reference	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect PLFS status and reference period through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not infer job quality from an employment headcount.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Unemployment rate and denominator converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 5 - CORE - PLFS status and reference periods

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: PLFS status and reference periods explains how Unemployment typology fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, PLFS status and reference periods separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

PLFS status and reference periods must be read through Unemployment typology, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- PLFS
- status
- reference
- periods
- Unemployment
- typology

How to use them: Define PLFS, status, reference; attach periods to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not equate skill certification with placement or wage progression.

VISUAL FIRST

PLFS STATUS AND REFERENCE PERIODS

01. Unemployment typology

BOUNDARY -> Do not equate skill certification with placement or wage progression.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not equate skill certification with placement or wage progression.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Unemployment typology
- **Qualified use:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS PLFS status reference periods Unemployment typology	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Unemployment typology through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not equate skill certification with placement or wage progression.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PLFS status and reference periods converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion

SESSION 6 - CORE - Types of unemployment

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Types of unemployment explains how Human-capital formation and Skill and placement boundary fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Types of unemployment separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Types of unemployment must be read through Human-capital formation and Skill and placement boundary, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Types**
- **unemployment**
- **Human-capital**
- **formation**
- **Skill**
- **placement**

How to use them: Define Types, unemployment, Human-capital; attach formation to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not describe the demographic dividend as automatic or permanent.

VISUAL FIRST

TYPES OF UNEMPLOYMENT

01. Human-capital formation

|

v

02. Skill and placement boundary

BOUNDARY -> Do not describe the demographic dividend as automatic or permanent.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.
- A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not describe the demographic dividend as automatic or permanent.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Human-capital formation -> Skill and placement boundary
- **Qualified use:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Types unemployment Human-capital formation Skill placement	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Human-capital formation and Skill and placement boundary through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not describe the demographic dividend as automatic or permanent.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Types of unemployment converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 7 - CORE - Human-capital formation

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Human-capital formation explains how PMKVY scope fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Human-capital formation separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Human-capital formation must be read through PMKVY scope, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Human-capital**
- **formation**
- **PMKVY**
- **scope**
- **Pradhan**
- **Mantri**

How to use them: Define Human-capital, formation, PMKVY; attach scope to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not equate unpaid care's GDP exclusion with absence of economic value.

VISUAL FIRST

HUMAN-CAPITAL FORMATION

01. PMKVY scope

BOUNDARY -> Do not equate unpaid care's GDP exclusion with absence of economic value.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not equate unpaid care's GDP exclusion with absence of economic value.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** PMKVY scope
- **Qualified use:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Human-capital formation PMKVY scope Pradhan Mantri	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect PMKVY scope through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not equate unpaid care's GDP exclusion with absence of economic value.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Human-capital formation converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 8 - CORE - Skill certification and placement

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Skill certification and placement explains how Apprenticeship mechanism fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Skill certification and placement separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Skill certification and placement must be read through Apprenticeship mechanism, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Skill
- certification
- placement

- Apprenticeship
- mechanism
- Apprenticeships

How to use them: Define Skill, certification, placement; attach Apprenticeship to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not merge Labour-Code enactment, commencement, rules and enforcement.

VISUAL FIRST

SKILL CERTIFICATION AND PLACEMENT

01. Apprenticeship mechanism

BOUNDARY -> Do not merge Labour-Code enactment, commencement, rules and enforcement.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not merge Labour-Code enactment, commencement, rules and enforcement.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Apprenticeship mechanism
- **Qualified use:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Skill certification placement Apprenticeship mechanism Apprenticeships	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Apprenticeship mechanism through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not merge Labour-Code enactment, commencement, rules and enforcement.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Skill certification and placement converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 9 - CORE - PMKVY and apprenticeships

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: PMKVY and apprenticeships explains how Demographic-dividend condition fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, PMKVY and apprenticeships separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

PMKVY and apprenticeships must be read through Demographic-dividend condition, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- PMKVY
- apprenticeships
- Demographic-dividend
- condition
- favourable
- working-age

How to use them: Define PMKVY, apprenticeships, Demographic-dividend; attach condition to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not assume Central Rules establish uniform state implementation.

VISUAL FIRST

PMKVY AND APPRENTICESHIPS

01. Demographic-dividend condition

BOUNDARY -> Do not assume Central Rules establish uniform state implementation.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not assume Central Rules establish uniform state implementation.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Demographic-dividend condition
- **Qualified use:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS PMKVY apprenticeships Demographic-dividend condition favourable working-age	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Demographic-dividend condition through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not assume Central Rules establish uniform state implementation.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PMKVY and apprenticeships converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 10 - CORE - Demographic dividend

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Demographic dividend explains how Female participation and care fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Demographic dividend separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Demographic dividend must be read through Female participation and care, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Demographic
- dividend
- Female
- participation
- care
- Women's

How to use them: Define Demographic, dividend, Female; attach participation to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not infer an objective PYQ answer letter from the routed ledger.

VISUAL FIRST

DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

01. Female participation and care

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer an objective PYQ answer letter from the routed ledger.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer an objective PYQ answer letter from the routed ledger.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Female participation and care
- **Qualified use:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

Demographic | dividend | Female | participation | care | Women's

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

connect Female participation and care through accounting, incentives and transmission

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not infer an objective PYQ answer letter from the routed ledger.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Demographic dividend converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion

SESSION 11 - CORE - Female participation

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Female participation explains how Care and monetised economy and Four Labour Codes fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Female participation separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Female participation must be read through Care and monetised economy and Four Labour Codes, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Female
- participation
- Care
- monetised
- Four
- Labour

How to use them: Define Female, participation, Care; attach monetised to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not use total population as the unemployment-rate denominator.

VISUAL FIRST

FEMALE PARTICIPATION

01. Care and monetised economy

|
v

02. Four Labour Codes

BOUNDARY -> Do not use total population as the unemployment-rate denominator.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.
- The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not use total population as the unemployment-rate denominator.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Care and monetised economy -> Four Labour Codes
- **Qualified use:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Female participation Care monetised Four Labour	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Care and monetised economy and Four Labour Codes through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not use total population as the unemployment-rate denominator.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Female participation converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 12 - CORE - Care economy and monetised economy

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Care economy and monetised economy explains how Enactment and commencement fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Care economy and monetised economy separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Care economy and monetised economy must be read through Enactment and commencement, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Care
- monetised
- Enactment
- commencement
- notification
- central

How to use them: Define Care, monetised, Enactment; attach commencement to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not treat people outside the labour force as unemployed.

VISUAL FIRST

CARE ECONOMY AND MONETISED ECONOMY

01. Enactment and commencement

BOUNDARY -> Do not treat people outside the labour force as unemployed.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not treat people outside the labour force as unemployed.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Enactment and commencement
- **Qualified use:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Care monetised Enactment commencement notification central	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Enactment and commencement through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not treat people outside the labour force as unemployed.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Care economy and monetised economy converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - The four Labour Codes

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The four Labour Codes explains how Current Labour-Code status fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, The four Labour Codes separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The four Labour Codes must be read through Current Labour-Code status, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- four
- Labour
- Codes

- Labour-Code
- status
- Official

How to use them: Define four, Labour, Codes; attach Labour-Code to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not quote PLFS data without status, reference period, age group and geography.

VISUAL FIRST

THE FOUR LABOUR CODES

01. Current Labour-Code status

BOUNDARY -> Do not quote PLFS data without status, reference period, age group and geography.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not quote PLFS data without status, reference period, age group and geography.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Current Labour-Code status
- **Qualified use:** Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS four Labour Codes Labour-Code status Official	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Current Labour-Code status through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Begin with the indicator, denominator and reference period before interpreting a labour-market trend.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not quote PLFS data without status, reference period, age group and geography.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The four Labour Codes converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Commencement, rules and Concurrent-List implementation

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Commencement, rules and Concurrent-List implementation explains how Concurrent-List implementation and Gig and platform work fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Commencement, rules and Concurrent-List implementation separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Commencement, rules and Concurrent-List implementation must be read through Concurrent-List implementation and Gig and platform work, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Commencement
- rules
- Concurrent-List
- implementation
- platform
- work

How to use them: Define Commencement, rules, Concurrent-List; attach implementation to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not infer job quality from an employment headcount.

VISUAL FIRST

COMMENCEMENT, RULES AND CONCURRENT-LIST IMPLEMENTATION

01. Concurrent-List implementation

|

v

02. Gig and platform work

BOUNDARY -> Do not infer job quality from an employment headcount.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.
- Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not infer job quality from an employment headcount.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Concurrent-List implementation -> Gig and platform work
- **Qualified use:** Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Commencement rules Concurrent-List implementation platform work	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Concurrent-List implementation and Gig and platform work through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Trace training through employer demand, placement, retention, earnings and productivity.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not infer job quality from an employment headcount.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Gig work, employment forms and productivity-led job creation

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Gig work, employment forms and productivity-led job creation explains how Fixed-term and casual work boundary and Productivity and job creation fit into one examinable economic mechanism.

Technical definition: In Economy analysis, Gig work, employment forms and productivity-led job creation separates the concept and accounting boundary from its unit, coverage, price basis, base year or basket, estimate vintage, institutional or legal source, crop and geography scope, eligibility, implementation stage, stock-flow boundary, transmission channel and distributional or stability consequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Gig work, employment forms and productivity-led job creation must be read through Fixed-term and casual work boundary and Productivity and job creation, with the formula or legal perimeter stated before the policy inference.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- work
- employment
- forms
- productivity-led
- creation
- Fixed-term

How to use them: Define work, employment, forms; attach productivity-led to its named source, period and status; then qualify the answer with this limit: Do not equate skill certification with placement or wage progression.

VISUAL FIRST

GIG WORK, EMPLOYMENT FORMS AND PRODUCTIVITY-LED JOB CREATION

01. Fixed-term and casual work boundary

|
v

02. Productivity and job creation

BOUNDARY -> Do not equate skill certification with placement or wage progression.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.
- Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Do not equate skill certification with placement or wage progression.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Preserve the exact formula, territorial or resident boundary, price basis, base year, index basket, eligible counterparty, institution and legal status; never upgrade a projection into an actual or a regulatory direction into a universal rule.
- **Mains:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

MINI RECAP

- **Mechanism chain:** Fixed-term and casual work boundary -> Productivity and job creation
- **Qualified use:** Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS work employment forms productivity-led creation Fixed-term	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT connect Fixed-term and casual work boundary and Productivity and job creation through accounting, incentives and transmission	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Balance flexibility and job creation with bargaining, safety and portable social protection.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not equate skill certification with placement or wage progression.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Gig work, employment forms and productivity-led job creation converts a precise economic distinction into a qualified conclusion			

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Economy | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-III + Prelims. **Core area:** Labour and human capital.
Grounded in: Ramesh Singh, relevant chapters; Economic Survey 2025-26; audited UPSC Economy PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical linkage | **CURRENT:** = current Survey/current-affairs hook. *Companion:*
../advanced/22_Employment-Labour-Codes-Skills-and-Demographic-Dividend.md.

1. Visual foundation

1. HEALTH AND EDUCATION
|
v
2. SKILLS AND LABOUR-FORCE PARTICIPATION
|
v
3. PRODUCTIVE JOB MATCHING
|
v
4. EARNINGS, PROTECTION AND MOBILITY
|
v
5. DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

Core proposition: Convert demographic potential into a dividend through participation, job creation, productivity, earnings and portable protection-not skill supply alone.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: LFPR	Share of the relevant population working or seeking work.
FACT: Worker-population ratio	Share of the relevant population that is employed.
FACT: Unemployment rate	Unemployed persons as a share of the labour force.
FACT: Demographic dividend	Potential growth benefit from a favourable working-age population structure.
FACT: Formalisation	Movement towards registered, rule-covered and documented economic relationships.

3. Topic mechanism

1. Health, foundational education and vocational preparation determine whether working-age

people can participate productively.

2. Care responsibilities, safety, mobility and social norms shape labour-force participation, especially for women.

3. Firms match workers to tasks through wages, contracts, apprenticeships and labour-market information.

4. Labour law sets minimum conditions, bargaining rules, social-security architecture and workplace safety.

5. Productivity growth and structural transformation determine whether employment gains translate into rising real earnings.

4. Institutions and policy tools

- FACT: **Ministry of Labour and Employment:** administers central labour policy, employment services and social-security institutions.

- FACT: **State labour departments:** frame state rules where required and enforce workplace provisions.

- FACT: **EPFO, ESIC and e-Shram architecture:** provide or support formal and portable social protection.

- FACT: **Skill-development ministries, Sector Skill Councils and employers:** connect training with occupational demand and apprenticeships.

5. Indian applications and examples

- FACT: **Claim:** India consolidated a fragmented labour-law framework into four named Codes, each replacing a specific cluster of older laws. **Evidence:** The Code on Wages, 2019; the Industrial Relations Code, 2020; the Code on Social Security, 2020; and the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020 together subsume 29 central labour laws. **Significance:** Naming each Code with its year is a baseline Prelims/Mains requirement and the precondition for any "merits and demerits" analysis. **Limitation/status caution:** The Codes were enacted in 2019-2020 but required central and state Rules before commencement; treat the commencement date and state-wise rule- notification status as requiring verification from a dated official source given how frequently this status has been updated.

- FACT: **Claim:** Codification's stated commencement date does not by itself prove uniform, nationwide operational readiness. **Evidence:** The four Labour Codes were notified to come into force on 21 November 2025, with final Central Rules notified in May 2026, but implementation additionally depends on each state notifying its own Rules and building inspection/enforcement capacity. **Significance:** This operationalises the "Centre-state legal and administrative readiness" mechanism step with the specific dated milestones already grounded in this file. **Limitation/status caution:** As of August 2026, state- level Rules-notification and enforcement-readiness status varies and should be treated as incomplete/uneven unless confirmed from a current, dated official source - do not assume uniform pan-India enforcement merely because central commencement has occurred.

- FACT: **Claim:** Concerns about labour-law reform balancing worker protection with ease of business are not new; an earlier official body examined the same tension. **Evidence:** The Second National Commission on Labour (2002, under the Ministry of Labour and Employment) reviewed and recommended consolidation and simplification of labour laws and stronger social-security coverage, laying groundwork later reflected in the four-Code consolidation. **Significance:** This gives the Codes a documented policy lineage rather than presenting them as a sudden, undebated change-useful for a "trace the evolution of labour reform" Mains answer. **Limitation:** A two-decade gap separates the Commission's recommendations from actual codification; using the Commission to claim continuous, uninterrupted reform momentum would overstate the historical record.

- FACT: **Claim:** Falling unemployment-rate headlines must be checked against participation and quality indicators, not read alone. **Evidence:** The Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS, conducted by the National Statistical Office) reports LFPR, worker-population ratio and unemployment rate on both usual-status and

current-weekly-status bases, along with sector and formality breakdowns. **Significance:** PLFS is the named, official data source that operationalises the Section 6 "falling unemployment rate can reflect discouraged workers" caution with a citable instrument. **Limitation:** PLFS estimates are survey-based with sampling and definitional caveats (e.g., usual-status vs weekly-status can differ); citing one measure without specifying its basis risks a Prelims-level error.

- **FACT: Claim:** Skill development policy has evolved a dedicated flagship scheme to link training with certification and employability, but certification alone is not employment. **Evidence:** The Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY), under the Skill India Mission, provides short-duration skill training with assessment and certification aligned to National Skills Qualification Framework levels. **Significance:** This is the named instrument operationalising the "training with limited value unless employers recognise the competency" caution already present in Section 6. **Limitation:** Certification under PMKVY does not guarantee placement or wage improvement; outcomes depend on employer recognition, sector demand and post-training support, which vary across trades and states.

- **ANALYSIS: Claim:** Gig and platform work is a genuinely growing but still incompletely measured segment of India's labour market. **Evidence:** The Code on Social Security, 2020 explicitly defines and extends social-security-scheme coverage to gig and platform workers for the first time in Indian labour law, and NITI Aayog's gig-economy work has separately estimated and projected the segment's growth. **Significance:** This shows policy recognition of a labour-market category preceding full data maturity-an important balance point for "new economy, old labour law" Mains answers. **Limitation/status caution:** Precise, dated gig-workforce counts should be cited only from the specific official report and year they come from; interpolating a figure for an unreported year overstates precision (see the corrected Section 8 caution).

- **ANALYSIS: Claim:** Converting demographic potential into a dividend depends on female labour-force participation, not aggregate LFPR alone. **Evidence:** Female LFPR (PLFS-reported) rose markedly between 2017-18 and 2023-24, though it remains below male LFPR and shows wide rural-urban and state-level variation. **Significance:** This operationalises the Section 3 "care responsibilities, safety, mobility and social norms shape... especially for women" mechanism step with a citable, dated indicator. **Limitation:** A rising headline female LFPR figure can partly reflect definitional/survey changes and increased reporting of unpaid family/agricultural work, so it should not be read as proof of proportionately rising quality employment for women without further disaggregation.

- **FACT: Claim:** "Unemployment" in India is not one undifferentiated condition; naming the correct type and its usual measurement window is a precondition for any structural- unemployment answer. **Evidence:** Standard typology distinguishes frictional (temporary job-search/transition), structural (skills-jobs mismatch from technological or sectoral change), cyclical (business-cycle downturn, historically muted in India given the large agriculture/informal cushion), seasonal (agriculture-linked, within-year) and disguised unemployment (surplus family labour, mainly in agriculture, whose removal would not reduce output); the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) captures these differently across its Usual Principal Status/Usual Principal-and-Subsidiary Status (UPS/UPSS, a 365-day reference best suited to structural and disguised unemployment), Current Weekly Status (CWS, a 7-day reference better suited to seasonal/frictional movement) and Current Daily Status (CDS, day-by-day, the most sensitive to partial/under-employment). **Significance:** This precisely answers the routed 2023 GS-III demand ("structural unemployment... and computation methodology improvements") by naming both the typology and the PLFS reference- period architecture that operationalises it, rather than treating "unemployment" as a single number. **Limitation:** Because CWS/CDS counts a person as employed with as little as one hour of work in the reference period, a low CWS-based unemployment rate can still conceal substantial underemployment and disguised unemployment that only a UPSS-based, disaggregated reading reveals; citing one status without naming it risks a Prelims-level and Mains-level precision error.

- **FACT: Claim:** The care economy is analytically distinct from the monetised economy because most care work in India is unpaid, and this distinction is itself a routed Mains demand. **Evidence:** The National Statistical Office's Time Use in India-2019 survey found women spend an average of about 299 minutes (nearly 5 hours) a day on unpaid domestic services against about 97 minutes for men, with 81.2% of women (versus 26.1% of men) participating in such unpaid work daily; this unpaid care work (childcare, eldercare, cooking, cleaning) falls outside the System of National Accounts production boundary and is therefore not counted in GDP even though it enables paid, monetised economic activity by other household members. **Significance:** This directly answers "distinguish the care economy from the monetised economy" with named, dated survey evidence, and explains why a purely monetised GDP-based view undercounts women's total economic contribution and understates a key constraint

on female LFPR (linking to the Section 3 mechanism and the female-LFPR unit above). **Limitation:** Time-use estimates are self-reported and survey-based (sampling and recall caveats apply); the 2019 round remains India's principal official time-use data point, so any later-year claim about narrowing the care-work gender gap should be attributed to a subsequent official survey, not assumed from the 2019 baseline alone.

- **ANALYSIS: Claim:** Building paid, formal care infrastructure is the policy route to convert unpaid care work into recognised employment, but this remains an early-stage effort in India. **Evidence:** Public childcare and eldercare provision in India runs mainly through the Anganwadi system (under the Integrated Child Development Services) and a small, growing private/NGO-run crèche and home-care sector, rather than through a large-scale, dedicated national care-infrastructure programme comparable to health or education spending.

Significance: This operationalises "recognise, reduce and redistribute unpaid care work" (the standard 3R policy framing referenced in care-economy literature) with a concrete institutional example and shows the formal-care-jobs route as a genuine but still limited instrument for both women's employment and demographic-dividend objectives.

Limitation: Anganwadi workers and helpers are themselves classified as honorary/volunteer functionaries in most states rather than regular formal employees, so citing Anganwadi expansion as "formal care-sector job creation" without this qualification would overstate the formality of the jobs actually created.

- **FACT: Claim:** The demographic dividend is a time-bound window defined by a favourable dependency ratio, not a permanent feature of having a young population, and India risks "ageing before it becomes rich" if the window closes before the dividend is captured. **Evidence:** The dependency ratio (population aged 0-14 and 60+/65+ as a share of the working-age 15-59/15-64 population) is currently more favourable for India than for rapidly ageing economies (such as China and several East Asian and European economies), but Government of India and UN population projections indicate India's working-age share will peak and then decline in the coming decades - meaning the "demographic window," the period when the dependency ratio is at its lowest, is time-limited rather than permanent. **Significance:** This operationalises "demographic dividend" as a favourable-dependency- ratio *window* rather than a static young-population fact, and grounds the "ageing before becoming rich" risk - the concern that India's dependency ratio could begin rising again before the country reaches upper-middle- or high-income status, unlike economies that industrialised and grew rich during their own low-dependency window. **Limitation:** Whether India converts its currently favourable dependency ratio into an actual dividend before the window narrows depends on the same participation, job-creation, productivity and human-capital conditions already discussed in Sections 3-5 of this file; a favourable dependency ratio by itself guarantees nothing without these conversion mechanisms.

5A. Reciprocal synthesis bridge - 2022 GS-II (inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes)

- **ANALYSIS: Routed demand:** 2022 GS-II, Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words - "Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes." This is a cross-cutting demand; Topic 22 (employment) and 03_Inflation-Price-Indices-and-Business-Cycles.md (inflation) jointly supply the answer-complete synthesis at Basic tier.

- **ANALYSIS: Cross-link:** inflation control, real wages, aggregate demand and job creation.

1. **Inflation control and real wages:** Persistent inflation erodes real wages for workers

whose nominal pay is not indexed - most of the informal workforce - reducing effective earnings even when headline employment looks stable (see Topic 03's CPI-IW indexation claim for who is and is not protected).

2. **Real wages and aggregate demand:** Falling real wages compress household purchasing power and consumption demand, which can slow labour-intensive, domestic-demand-dependent sectors (retail, construction, services) - linking price stability to job security through the demand channel, not only the credit channel.

3. **Aggregate demand and job creation:** Conversely, disinflation pursued through rate hikes that compresses aggregate demand too far can itself suppress job creation, particularly in MSMEs and construction (see Topic 03's Section 5A on disinflation's employment/MSME cost); correct sequencing therefore targets credible, moderate inflation control alongside labour-intensive growth (Sections 3-5 above: participation, labour-intensive manufacturing, the Labour Codes, skilling) rather than treating inflation and employment as a strict trade-off to be resolved by welfare transfers alone.

4. **Welfare-scheme limits:** schemes such as MGNREGA or PDS cushion the poor during a

price or employment shock but do not by themselves restore real wages or create durable formal jobs - they are a floor, not a structural solution.

- ANALYSIS: **Directive-decoder/answer-spine line:** For "Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes," pair this real-wage -> aggregate-demand -> job-creation chain with Topic 03's incidence-on-poor -> transfer-limits -> disinflation-cost -> structural-job- measures chain (its Section 5A) - a welfare-schemes-only answer is incomplete for this routed demand.

- FACT: **Reciprocal Study link:** see 03_Inflation-Price-Indices-and-Business-Cycles.md, Section 5A, for the inflation-side half of this synthesis (incidence on the poor, limits of transfers/indexation, disinflation's employment/MSME cost, supply-side measures).

Core limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: Codification simplifies compliance on paper, but staggered state-Rules notification means firms and workers can face genuine uncertainty about which provisions currently apply in a given state.

- ANALYSIS: Wage, social-security and safety thresholds embedded in the Codes (establishment size, contract-worker counts, etc.) can create incentives for firms to remain just below a threshold, limiting the intended expansion of formal coverage.

- ANALYSIS: Extending social-security coverage to gig/platform workers is a stated Code objective, but funding mechanisms, employer contribution obligations and portability design remain contested and incompletely operationalised.

- ANALYSIS: Skill-certification programmes (PMKVY) can expand credentialed supply without a matching increase in demand for those specific skills, producing certified-but- underemployed workers in some trades or regions.

- ANALYSIS: Rising aggregate employment or female-LFPR figures can mask a shift towards low-productivity, informal or unpaid work rather than genuine quality-job creation.

- ANALYSIS: Concurrent-List status of labour means Centre-level codification cannot by itself guarantee uniform enforcement; inspection capacity and political-economy incentives vary significantly by state.

- ANALYSIS: A single unemployment-rate headline can obscure which type (structural, frictional, cyclical, seasonal or disguised) is actually operating, and citing CWS/CDS-based figures without naming the reference period can understate structural and disguised unemployment that only UPSS-based, disaggregated data reveals.

- ANALYSIS: Unpaid care work's exclusion from GDP is a national-accounts convention, not evidence that it has no economic value; treating the care economy as "non-economic" understates both women's total contribution and a binding constraint on female LFPR.

- ANALYSIS: Formalising care work into paid jobs (crèches, elder-care services) remains a nascent sector in India, and Anganwadi-based estimates of "care employment" should be qualified by these workers' honorary/volunteer classification rather than treated as regular formal jobs.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: A person outside the labour force is not counted as unemployed.

- FACT: Employment quantity, productivity, earnings, security and working conditions are distinct.

- FACT: The four Labour Codes consolidate 29 central labour laws.

- FACT: The Codes cover wages, industrial relations, social security, and occupational safety, health and working conditions.

- FACT: Labour is in the Concurrent List, so implementation requires Centre-state legal and administrative readiness.

- FACT: Gig and platform work can expand flexibility while creating social-security and

bargaining challenges.

- FACT: Unemployment types - frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised - require different PLFS reference periods (UPS/UPSS for structural/disguised; CWS/CDS for seasonal/frictional and under-employment) to measure correctly.
- FACT: Unpaid care work (Time Use Survey 2019: about 299 minutes/day for women versus 97 for men) falls outside GDP's production boundary but is distinct from, and enables, the monetised economy.
- FACT: The demographic dividend depends on a favourable dependency ratio (working-age share relative to 0-14 and 60+/65+ population) and is a time-bound window, not a permanent young-population fact; India's working-age share is projected to peak and then decline, raising the "ageing before becoming rich" risk if the dividend is not captured in time.

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: A falling unemployment rate always means more jobs. -> People leaving the labour force can also lower the rate.
- WRONG: Demographic dividend is automatic. -> It requires health, education, skills, jobs and female participation.
- WRONG: All informal workers are self-employed. -> Informality cuts across employment statuses.
- WRONG: Labour Codes were only passed but not in force. -> They came into force on 21 Nov 2025.
- WRONG: Central Rules alone guarantee uniform implementation. -> State rules and enforcement readiness may vary.
- WRONG: Structural unemployment is the same as cyclical or seasonal unemployment. -> Each has a distinct cause and is best captured by a different PLFS reference period.
- WRONG: Unpaid care work has no economic significance because it is outside GDP. -> It enables monetised economic activity and is a binding constraint on female LFPR; exclusion from GDP is a national-accounts convention, not a value judgment.
- WRONG: A young population automatically guarantees a demographic dividend forever. -> The dividend depends on a time-bound favourable dependency ratio; the working-age share is projected to peak and then decline, so the window can close before the dividend is captured (the "ageing before enrichment" risk).

8. CURRENT: Economic Survey 2025-26 / current anchor

- CURRENT: The four Labour Codes came into force on 21 Nov 2025; final Central Rules were notified in May 2026.
- CURRENT: Q2 FY26 had 56.2 crore employed persons aged 15 years and above.
- CURRENT: Female LFPR rose from 23.3% in 2017-18 to 41.7% in 2023-24. ANALYSIS: **Status caution:** a previously stated "120 lakh gig workers in FY25" figure was an interpolated estimate, not an official measured data point, and has been removed; NITI Aayog's gig-economy report gave a 2020-21 baseline (about 77 lakh) and a 2029-30 projection - cite only the dated baseline/projection pair from the official report, never an interpolated in-between year.

ANALYSIS: **Interpretation caution:** Final Central Rules notified in May 2026 do not erase differences in state rules, inspection capacity and enforcement readiness.

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III asked merits, demerits and progress of the four Labour Codes.
- ANALYSIS: Current answer update: in force from 21 Nov 2025; final Central Rules notified in May 2026.
- ANALYSIS: **Answer engine:** merits-consolidation, wider wage/social-security architecture,

digital compliance and clarity; risks-thresholds, bargaining power, compliance cost, implementation capacity and gig-worker coverage; conclude with state rules, inspection, grievance redress and measured outcomes.

- ANALYSIS: 2023 GS-III: Structural unemployment in India and computation methodology

improvements - answer with the typology unit (frictional/structural/cyclical/seasonal/ disguised) and the PLFS UPS/UPSS-versus-CWS/CDS reference-period distinction above.

- ANALYSIS: 2023 GS-III: Distinguish the care economy from the monetised economy - answer with the Time Use Survey 2019 unpaid-care-work evidence, its exclusion from GDP's production boundary, and the Anganwadi-based formal-care-jobs limitation above.

- ANALYSIS: Demographic-dividend answers should open with the dependency-ratio/window framing above (favourable ratio now, projected to narrow later) rather than treating a young population as an automatic, permanent advantage.

Source: Ministry of Labour and Employment annual report 2025-26.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Use the jobs framework: participation, quantity, quality, productivity, protection and matching.
- ANALYSIS: Evaluate Labour Codes through simplification, flexibility, universalisation, federal readiness and enforcement.
- ANALYSIS: Convert demography into dividend through women-centred, apprenticeship-led and demand-linked policy.
- ANALYSIS: For a structural-unemployment question, name the type and its measurement window before diagnosing causes or remedies; for a care-economy question, keep the unpaid/monetised distinction explicit and link it to female LFPR.

Answer thesis: Convert demographic potential into a dividend through participation, job creation, productivity, earnings and portable protection-not skill supply alone.

11. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Distinguish LFPR, worker-population ratio and unemployment rate and identify the four Labour Codes.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Why can rapid economic growth coexist with weak employment quality?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Evaluate the Labour Codes after their 21 Nov 2025 commencement, including state readiness and gig-worker protection.

11A. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

Directive decoder

- "Discuss merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes" -> requires naming all four Codes with years, the 2025 commencement/2026 Central-Rules status caution, and state-readiness variation - never a generic "labour reform is good/bad" claim.
- "Why can growth coexist with weak employment quality" -> requires PLFS-based indicator precision (LFPR vs worker-population ratio vs unemployment rate) plus a named structural cause (informality, gig work, low female LFPR).
- "Evaluate demographic-dividend policy" -> requires linking health/education/skills (PMKVY) to participation (especially female LFPR) and job quality, not skill supply alone.
- "Examine structural unemployment and computation-methodology improvements" -> requires

naming all five unemployment types and the specific PLFS reference period (UPS/UPSS vs CWS/CDS) that captures each, not a single undifferentiated "unemployment rate".

- "Distinguish the care economy from the monetised economy" -> requires the Time Use Survey

2019 evidence, the GDP-production-boundary exclusion, and the Anganwadi-based formal- care-jobs limitation - not a generic statement that care work "should be valued".

- "Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes" (2022 GS-II) -> requires the Section 5A real-wage/aggregate-demand/job-creation chain paired with Topic 03's inflation-incidence/transfer-limits/disinflation-cost chain - never a generic "control inflation and create jobs" answer that leans on welfare schemes alone.

Evidence chain (claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation) Use the Section 5 bank: Codes-evaluation questions draw on the four-Code/2nd NCL/state- readiness units; jobs-quality questions draw on the PLFS/gig-worker units; dividend questions draw on the PMKVY/female-LFPR units; structural-unemployment questions draw on the typology/PLFS-reference-period unit; care-economy questions draw on the Time Use Survey/Anganwadi units.

Counter-evidence and balance Pair every reform or growth claim with its Core-limitation caution (threshold gaming, state-notification lag, credential-demand mismatch, informality masking) so the answer does not read as unqualified reform success.

10/15/20-mark scaling

- 10 marks (~150 words): thesis + 2-3 evidence units (e.g., four Codes + PLFS caution) + one limitation + verdict.
- 15 marks (~250 words): thesis + jobs-framework structure (participation -> quantity -> quality -> productivity -> protection) + 4-5 evidence units + counter-evidence + verdict.
- 20 marks (~250-300 words): add a comparative/causal dimension (pre-Code versus post-Code regime, or male versus female LFPR trajectories) + 5-7 evidence units + explicit trade- offs + a fully reasoned verdict.

Reasoned verdict template "The four Labour Codes (Wages 2019; Industrial Relations, Social Security, and OSH&WC,

2020. consolidate 29 laws and, since their 21 Nov 2025 commencement and May 2026 Central Rules, extend coverage to gig workers, but [name the specific state-readiness/threshold/ informality constraint the question asks about] means the demographic dividend remains conditional - therefore [qualified, directive-matching conclusion]."

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion:
../advanced/22_Employment-Labour-Codes-Skills-and-Demographic-Dividend.md.
- FACT: 02_Growth-Development-HDI-IHDI-and-MPI.md - capability formation.
- FACT: 17_MSMEs-PLI-Semiconductors-and-Manufacturing-Strategy.md - labour-intensive and technical manufacturing demand.
- FACT: 24_Services-Digital-Economy-Fintech-and-Platform-Markets.md - platform work and algorithmic management.
- FACT: 03_Inflation-Price-Indices-and-Business-Cycles.md - reciprocal synthesis bridge (Section 5A) for the routed 2022 GS-II demand on managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-III

- Routed question demands: 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-III	11	Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 11

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	49	Human capital formation concept and its meaning	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2018	Prelims GS-I	78	Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana scope provisions and ministry	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	60	Fixed-term employment rules under Industrial Employment Act	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	58	Post-1991 liberalisation rural urban worker productivity trends	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	2	Casual workers EPF coverage and wage payment	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	GS-II	16	Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Cross-cutting; both Economy routes terminate in answer-complete Core	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-III	11	Labour productivity led growth and job creation pattern suggestion	Explain · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	Prelims GS-I	71	Agency compiling industrial disputes data in India	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	GS-II	18	Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment	Analyse the linkages · 15 marks · 250 words	Both subject routes terminate in answer-complete Core	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-III	11	Structural unemployment in India and computation methodology improvements	Examine · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-III	12	Distinction between care economy and monetized economy integration	Distinguish · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic; stem verified against official scan; OCR artifact resolved	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Human capital formation concept and its meaning
- Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana scope provisions and ministry
- Fixed-term employment rules under Industrial Employment Act
- Post-1991 liberalisation rural urban worker productivity trends
- Casual workers EPF coverage and wage payment

- Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes
- Labour productivity led growth and job creation pattern suggestion
- Agency compiling industrial disputes data in India
- Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment
- Structural unemployment in India and computation methodology improvements
- Distinction between care economy and monetized economy integration

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

- **Official syllabus/index and owned core:** Employment analysis separates labour force, workforce, unemployment, labour-force participation, worker-population ratio, job quality and productivity; skills and demographic dividend depend on health, education, demand and mobility.
- **Indispensable distinction and prerequisite taxonomy:** Unemployment rate denominator is labour force, not population; labour-force participation is not employment rate, enactment is not commencement of labour-code provisions, registration is not social-security coverage, and demographic dividend is not automatic.
- **Mechanism, implementation and evidence control:** Name PLFS status, reference period, usual/current status and age/sex/geography denominator; distinguish law, rules and operational commencement, and analyse informality, wages, care, migration, technology and demand without causal overreach.
- **FACT: Verified current fact (official sources rechecked 5 September 2026):**

Rechecked 6 September 2026 against the listed official publisher or regulator source. Official Ministry search results support commencement on 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026. Direct pages and the annual-report PDF returned HTTP 403, so no state-by-state rule count, employment value, scheme target or outlay was added. Sources: <https://labour.gov.in/offering/schemes-and-services/details/labour-codes-gzNzQzMtQWw>; <https://www.labour.gov.in/documents/acts-and-policies>

- **ANALYSIS: Analytical inference:** institutional design, allocation, a portal, a registration, a report, a training completion, a disposal count or a ranking can support a causal argument only after authority, capacity, incentives, distribution, implementation, grievance, outcome and alternative explanations are tested.

- **Canonical and cross-owner boundary:** this Economy owner teaches the authority-to-delivery-to-remedy chain. Detailed constitutional doctrine stays with Polity; sector entitlement design stays with Social Justice; macro-fiscal doctrine stays with Economy; ethics theory stays with Ethics. Cross-owner evidence may be routed but is not silently duplicated or re-owned.

- **Four-ledger hostile audit:** literal syllabus, indispensable prerequisites, standard public-administration/economy taxonomy and complete verified PYQ demands were checked for absent concepts, institutions, mechanisms, classifications, exceptions, comparisons, criticisms, current status, answer architecture and dependent artifacts.

- **Verified PYQ ownership, 2018-2026:** Audited ledgers route Mains demands on productivity-led job creation, structural-unemployment measurement, the care economy, Labour Codes, inflation and unemployment, and skill-to-employment linkages, plus objective concepts on human capital, PMKVY, fixed-term work, casual workers and industrial-dispute statistics. No objective key is inferred.

ECONOMY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Employment analysis separates labour force, workforce, unemployment, labour-force participation, worker-population ratio, job quality and productivity; skills and demographic dividend depend on health, education, demand and mobility.
- **Close distinction:** Unemployment rate denominator is labour force, not population; labour-force participation is not employment rate, enactment is not commencement of labour-code provisions, registration is not social-security coverage, and demographic dividend is not automatic.
- **Formula / status / evidence / causal limit:** Name PLFS status, reference period, usual/current status and age/sex/geography denominator; distinguish law, rules and operational commencement, and analyse informality, wages, care, migration, technology and demand without causal overreach.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Employment-quality frame?

A. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. B. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. C. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: A. Explanation: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q2. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Employment-quality frame?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. C. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. D. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Answer: B. Explanation: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q3. Which statement uses Employment-quality frame without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. B. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. C. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. D. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.

Answer: C. Explanation: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Employment-quality frame?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. D. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Answer: D. Explanation: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies LFPR denominator?

A. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. B. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. C. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. D. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Answer: A. Explanation: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q6. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of LFPR denominator?

A. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. B. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. C. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. D. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.

Answer: B. Explanation: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q7. Which statement uses LFPR denominator without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. D. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.

Answer: C. Explanation: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about LFPR denominator?

A. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. B. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. C. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: D. Explanation: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Worker-population ratio?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. C. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. D. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.

Answer: A. Explanation: The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q10. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Worker-population ratio?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. C. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. D. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.

Answer: B. Explanation: The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q11. Which statement uses Worker-population ratio without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. B. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. C. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. D. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Worker-population ratio?

A. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. B. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. C. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. D. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.

Answer: D. Explanation: The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Unemployment-rate denominator?

A. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. B. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. C. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. D. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.

Answer: A. Explanation: The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q14. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Unemployment-rate denominator?

A. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. B. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. C. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. D. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q15. Which statement uses Unemployment-rate denominator without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. B. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. C. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. D. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

Answer: C. Explanation: The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Unemployment-rate denominator?

A. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. B. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. C. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: D. Explanation: The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies PLFS status and reference period?

A. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. D. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q18. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of PLFS status and reference period?

A. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. B. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. C. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. D. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

Answer: B. Explanation: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q19. Which statement uses PLFS status and reference period without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. B. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. C. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. D. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Answer: C. Explanation: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PLFS status and reference period?

A. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. B. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. C. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. D. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Answer: D. Explanation: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Unemployment typology?

A. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. B. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. C. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. D. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

Answer: A. Explanation: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q22. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Unemployment typology?

A. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. B. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. C. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. D. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Answer: B. Explanation: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q23. Which statement uses Unemployment typology without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. B. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. C. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. D. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

Answer: C. Explanation: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Unemployment typology?

A. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. B. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. C. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. D. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.

Answer: D. Explanation: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Human-capital formation?

A. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. B. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. C. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. D. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q26. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Human-capital formation?

A. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. B. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. C. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. D. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

Answer: B. Explanation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q27. Which statement uses Human-capital formation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. B. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. C. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. D. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Human-capital formation?

A. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. B. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. C. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. D. Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.

Answer: D. Explanation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Skill and placement boundary?

A. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. B. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. C. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. D. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

Answer: A. Explanation: A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q30. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Skill and placement boundary?

A. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. B. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. C. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. D. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

Answer: B. Explanation: A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q31. Which statement uses Skill and placement boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. B. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. C. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. D. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Skill and placement boundary?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. C. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. D. A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies PMKVY scope?

A. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. B. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. C. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. D. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q34. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of PMKVY scope?

A. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. B. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. C. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. D. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.

Answer: B. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q35. Which statement uses PMKVY scope without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. C. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. D. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Answer: C. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PMKVY scope?

A. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. B. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. C. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. D. Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.

Answer: D. Explanation: Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Apprenticeship mechanism?

A. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. B. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. C. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. D. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.

Answer: A. Explanation: Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q38. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Apprenticeship mechanism?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. C. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. D. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Answer: B. Explanation: Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q39. Which statement uses Apprenticeship mechanism without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. B. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. C. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: C. Explanation: Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Apprenticeship mechanism?

A. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. B. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. C. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. D. Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Answer: D. Explanation: Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Demographic-dividend condition?

A. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. B. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. C. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. D. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Answer: A. Explanation: A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q42. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Demographic-dividend condition?

A. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. B. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. C. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: B. Explanation: A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q43. Which statement uses Demographic-dividend condition without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. B. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. C. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. D. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Answer: C. Explanation: A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Demographic-dividend condition?

A. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. B. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. C. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. D. A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.

Answer: D. Explanation: A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Female participation and care?

A. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. B. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. C. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q46. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Female participation and care?

A. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. B. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. C. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. D. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Answer: B. Explanation: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q47. Which statement uses Female participation and care without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. B. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. C. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. D. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.

Answer: C. Explanation: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Female participation and care?

A. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. B. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. C. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. D. Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Care and monetised economy?

A. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. B. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. C. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. D. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Answer: A. Explanation: Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q50. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Care and monetised economy?

A. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. B. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. C. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. D. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.

Answer: B. Explanation: Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q51. Which statement uses Care and monetised economy without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. B. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. C. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. D. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Answer: C. Explanation: Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Care and monetised economy?

A. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. B. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. C. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. D. Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Four Labour Codes?

A. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. B. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. C. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. D. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q54. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Four Labour Codes?

A. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. B. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. C. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. D. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q55. Which statement uses Four Labour Codes without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. B. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. C. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. D. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Four Labour Codes?

A. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. B. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. C. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. D. The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Enactment and commencement?

A. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. B. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. C. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. D. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Answer: A. Explanation: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q58. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Enactment and commencement?

A. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. B. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. C. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. D. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Answer: B. Explanation: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q59. Which statement uses Enactment and commencement without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. B. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. C. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. D. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Answer: C. Explanation: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Enactment and commencement?

A. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. B. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. C. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. D. Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Current Labour-Code status?

A. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. B. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. C. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. D. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Answer: A. Explanation: Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q62. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Current Labour-Code status?

A. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. B. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. C. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. D. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Answer: B. Explanation: Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. The other options belong to different measures,

vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q63. Which statement uses Current Labour-Code status without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. B. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. C. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. D. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Answer: C. Explanation: Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Current Labour-Code status?

A. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. B. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. C. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. D. Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Answer: D. Explanation: Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Concurrent-List implementation?

A. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. B. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. C. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. D. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Answer: A. Explanation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q66. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Concurrent-List implementation?

A. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. B. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. C. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. D. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Answer: B. Explanation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q67. Which statement uses Concurrent-List implementation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. B. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. C. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: C. Explanation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Concurrent-List implementation?

A. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. B. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. C. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. D. Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.

Answer: D. Explanation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Gig and platform work?

A. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. B. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. C. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. D. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Answer: A. Explanation: Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q70. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Gig and platform work?

A. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. B. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. C. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: B. Explanation: Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q71. Which statement uses Gig and platform work without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. B. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. C. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. D. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.

Answer: C. Explanation: Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Gig and platform work?

A. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. B. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. C. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. D. Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Answer: D. Explanation: Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Fixed-term and casual work boundary?

A. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. B. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. C. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. D. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Answer: A. Explanation: Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q74. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Fixed-term and casual work boundary?

A. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. B. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. C. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. D. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.

Answer: B. Explanation: Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q75. Which statement uses Fixed-term and casual work boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. B. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. C. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: C. Explanation: Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Fixed-term and casual work boundary?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. C. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. D. Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Answer: D. Explanation: Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Productivity and job creation?

A. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. B. Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. C. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. D. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.

Answer: A. Explanation: Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q78. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Productivity and job creation?

A. The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. B. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. C. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. D. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

Answer: B. Explanation: Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q79. Which statement uses Productivity and job creation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. B. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. C. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. D. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Answer: C. Explanation: Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Productivity and job creation?

A. The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. B. PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. C. Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. D. Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Answer: D. Explanation: Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route Mains demands on productivity-led job creation, structural-unemployment measurement, the care economy, Labour Codes, inflation and unemployment, and skill-to-employment linkages, plus objective concepts on human capital, PMKVY, fixed-term work, casual workers and industrial-dispute statistics. No objective key is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III asked merits, demerits and progress of the four Labour Codes.
- ANALYSIS: Current answer update: in force from 21 Nov 2025; final Central Rules notified in May 2026.
- ANALYSIS: **Answer engine:** merits-consolidation, wider wage/social-security architecture, digital compliance and clarity; risks-thresholds, bargaining power, compliance cost, implementation capacity and gig-worker coverage; conclude with state rules, inspection, grievance redress and measured outcomes.
- ANALYSIS: 2023 GS-III: Structural unemployment in India and computation methodology improvements - answer with the typology unit (frictional/structural/cyclical/seasonal/ disguised) and the PLFS UPS/UPSS-versus-CWS/CDS reference-period distinction above.
- ANALYSIS: 2023 GS-III: Distinguish the care economy from the monetised economy - answer with the

Time Use Survey 2019 unpaid-care-work evidence, its exclusion from GDP's production boundary, and the Anganwadi-based formal-care-jobs limitation above.

- **ANALYSIS:** Demographic-dividend answers should open with the dependency-ratio/window framing above (favourable ratio now, projected to narrow later) rather than treating a young population as an automatic, permanent advantage.

Source: Ministry of Labour and Employment annual report 2025-26.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-III	11	Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 11

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Prelims GS-I	49	Human capital formation concept and its meaning	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2018	Prelims GS-I	78	Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana scope provisions and ministry	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	Prelims GS-I	60	Fixed-term employment rules under Industrial Employment Act	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	58	Post-1991 liberalisation rural urban worker productivity trends	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	Prelims GS-I	2	Casual workers EPF coverage and wage payment	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2022	GS-II	16	Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Cross-cutting; both Economy routes terminate in answer-complete Core	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-III	11	Labour productivity led growth and job creation pattern suggestion	Explain · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	Prelims GS-I	71	Agency compiling industrial disputes data in India	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2023	GS-II	18	Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment	Analyse the linkages · 15 marks · 250 words	Both subject routes terminate in answer-complete Core	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-III	11	Structural unemployment in India and computation methodology improvements	Examine · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-III	12	Distinction between care economy and monetized economy integration	Distinguish · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic; stem verified against official scan; OCR artifact resolved	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Human capital formation concept and its meaning
- Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana scope provisions and ministry
- Fixed-term employment rules under Industrial Employment Act
- Post-1991 liberalisation rural urban worker productivity trends
- Casual workers EPF coverage and wage payment

- Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes
- Labour productivity led growth and job creation pattern suggestion
- Agency compiling industrial disputes data in India
- Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment
- Structural unemployment in India and computation methodology improvements
- Distinction between care economy and monetized economy integration

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III asked merits, demerits and progress of the four Labour Codes.
- ANALYSIS: Current answer update: in force from 21 Nov 2025; final Central Rules notified in May

2026.

- ANALYSIS: **Answer engine:** benefits-consolidation, wage coverage, portable protection and compliance clarity; tensions-flexibility versus security, thresholds and bargaining, state capacity, platform-worker implementation and enforcement; assess outcomes rather than enactment alone.

Source: Ministry of Labour and Employment annual report 2025-26.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2022	GS-II	16	Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Cross-cutting; the stem names both inflation and unemployment	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	18	Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment	Analyse the linkages · 15 marks · 250 words	Social Justice Core route; Economy employment link retained	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes
- Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 GS-III

Demand: Labour-productivity-led growth and the job-creation pattern India should follow.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: Employment-quality frame: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Human-capital formation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Apprenticeship mechanism:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Productivity and job creation:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Employment-quality frame: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Human-capital formation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Apprenticeship mechanism:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Productivity and job creation:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Labour-productivity-led growth and the job-creation pattern India should follow. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Employment-quality frame: Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.

Human-capital formation: Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Apprenticeship mechanism:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Productivity and job creation:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2022 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 GS-III

Demand: Structural unemployment in India and improvements in computation methodology.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger.

Model solution: LFPR denominator: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Worker-population ratio:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Unemployment-rate denominator:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

PLFS status and reference period: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Unemployment typology: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: LFPR denominator: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Worker-population ratio:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Unemployment-rate denominator:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.

PLFS status and reference period: PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Unemployment typology: Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Structural unemployment in India and improvements in computation methodology. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2018-2023 GS-III ledger. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: LFPR denominator: The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Worker-population ratio:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Unemployment-rate denominator:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **PLFS status and reference period:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Unemployment typology:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2023 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2023 GS-III

Demand: Distinguish the care economy from the monetised economy and explain their integration.

Status: Official scan wording is recorded as verified in the audited routing ledger.

Model solution: Female participation and care: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Care and monetised economy:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Gig and platform work:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2023 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Female participation and care: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Care and monetised economy:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Gig and platform work:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Distinguish the care economy from the monetised economy and explain their integration. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official scan wording is recorded as verified in the audited routing ledger. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Female participation and care: Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Care and monetised economy:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Gig and platform work:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2023 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 GS-III

Demand: Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes.

Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2024-2025 GS-III ledger; current status is separately dated.

Model solution: Four Labour Codes: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Enactment and commencement:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Current Labour-Code status:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Concurrent-List implementation:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Fixed-term and casual work boundary:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Four Labour Codes: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Enactment and commencement: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Current Labour-Code status:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Concurrent-List implementation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Fixed-term and casual work boundary:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Merits and demerits of the four Labour Codes. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Official-paper demand routed in the audited 2024-2025 GS-III ledger; current status is separately dated. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Four Labour Codes: The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.

Enactment and commencement: Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Current Labour-Code status:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.

Concurrent-List implementation: Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Fixed-term and casual work boundary:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2024 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish LFPR, worker-population ratio and unemployment rate. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** LFPR denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Worker-population ratio. **Named evidence/example:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment-rate denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS status and reference period. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.
- The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.
- The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.
- PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** LFPR denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Worker-population ratio. **Named evidence/example:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment-rate denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS status and reference

period. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Distinguish LFPR, worker-population ratio and unemployment rate. Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: LFPR denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Worker-population ratio. **Named evidence/example:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment-rate denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS status and reference period. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: LFPR denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Worker-population ratio. **Named evidence/example:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim: Unemployment-rate denominator. **Named evidence/example:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PLFS status and reference period. **Named evidence/example:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Distinguish LFPR, worker-population ratio and unemployment rate. Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why is skill certification not an adequate employment outcome? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Skill and placement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PMKVY scope. **Named evidence/example:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.
- A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.
- Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.
- Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Skill and placement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PMKVY scope. **Named evidence/example:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill

mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why is skill certification not an adequate employment outcome? Answer in about 150 words.", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Skill and placement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PMKVY scope. **Named evidence/example:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Skill and placement boundary. **Named evidence/example:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** PMKVY scope. **Named evidence/example:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Why is skill certification not an adequate employment outcome? Answer in about 150 words.", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain how India can convert demographic potential into a demographic dividend. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Demographic-dividend condition. **Named evidence/example:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.
- A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.
- Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.
- Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Demographic-dividend condition. **Named evidence/example:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices,

distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain how India can convert demographic potential into a demographic dividend. Answer in...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Demographic-dividend condition. **Named evidence/example:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Demographic-dividend condition. **Named evidence/example:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain how India can convert demographic potential into a demographic dividend. Answer in...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Discuss the relationship between the care economy and women's labour-force participation. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Care and monetised economy. **Named evidence/example:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.
- Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.
- Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Care and monetised economy. **Named evidence/example:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on "Discuss the relationship between the care economy and women's labour-force participation....", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Care and monetised economy. **Named evidence/example:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Female participation and care. **Named evidence/example:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Care and monetised economy. **Named evidence/example:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and

geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Discuss the relationship between the care economy and women's labour-force participation....", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the four Labour Codes through legal status, worker protection, firm incentives and state capacity. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Four Labour Codes. **Named evidence/example:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Enactment and commencement. **Named evidence/example:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Current Labour-Code status. **Named evidence/example:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Concurrent-List implementation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Fixed-term and casual work boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather

than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.
- Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.
- Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.
- Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.
- Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Four Labour Codes. **Named evidence/example:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Enactment and commencement. **Named evidence/example:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Current Labour-Code status. **Named evidence/example:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Concurrent-List implementation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Fixed-term and casual work boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate the four Labour Codes through legal status, worker protection, firm incentives and...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Four Labour Codes. **Named evidence/example:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or

accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Enactment and commencement. **Named evidence/example:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Current Labour-Code status. **Named evidence/example:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Concurrent-List implementation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Fixed-term and casual work boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status,

source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Four Labour Codes. **Named evidence/example:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Enactment and commencement. **Named evidence/example:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Current Labour-Code status. **Named evidence/example:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Concurrent-List implementation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Fixed-term and casual work boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate the four Labour Codes through legal status, worker protection, firm incentives and...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and

qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Design an employment strategy that combines productivity, labour demand, skills and portable protection. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Employment-quality frame. **Named evidence/example:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment typology. **Named evidence/example:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.
- Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.
- Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.
- Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.
- Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.

- Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Employment-quality frame. **Named evidence/example:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment typology. **Named evidence/example:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Design an employment strategy that combines productivity, labour demand, skills and portable...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Employment-quality frame. **Named evidence/example:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment typology. **Named evidence/example:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base

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Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** Connect the

identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Employment-quality frame. **Named evidence/example:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Unemployment typology. **Named evidence/example:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Human-capital formation. **Named evidence/example:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Apprenticeship mechanism. **Named evidence/example:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Gig and platform work. **Named evidence/example:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Productivity and job creation. **Named evidence/example:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis ->

qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

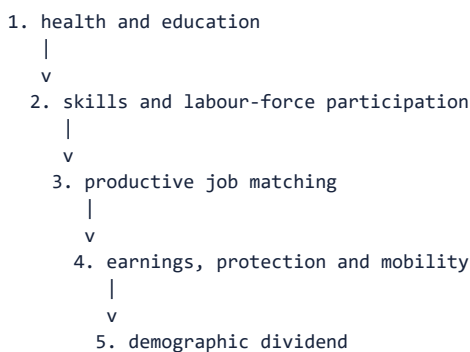
Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Design an employment strategy that combines productivity, labour demand, skills and portable...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Economy | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-III + Prelims. **Core area:** Labour and human capital.
Grounded in: Ramesh Singh, relevant chapters; Economic Survey 2025-26; audited UPSC Economy PYQs (2024-2026 Prelims and 2024-2025 Mains). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current Survey/current-affairs hook. *Companion:*
../basic/22_Employment-Labour-Codes-Skills-and-Demographic-Dividend.md.

1. Architecture



Analytical claim: Convert demographic potential into a dividend through participation, job creation, productivity, earnings and portable protection-not skill supply alone.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: LFPR	Share of the relevant population working or seeking work.
FACT: Worker-population ratio	Share of the relevant population that is employed.
FACT: Unemployment rate	Unemployed persons as a share of the labour force.
FACT: Demographic dividend	Potential growth benefit from a favourable working-age population structure.
FACT: Formalisation	Movement towards registered, rule-covered and documented economic relationships.

3. Detailed transmission

1. Health, foundational education and vocational preparation determine whether working-age people can participate productively.
2. Care responsibilities, safety, mobility and social norms shape labour-force participation, especially for women.
3. Firms match workers to tasks through wages, contracts, apprenticeships and labour-market information.
4. Labour law sets minimum conditions, bargaining rules, social-security architecture and

workplace safety.

5. Productivity growth and structural transformation determine whether employment gains translate into rising real earnings.

Deeper analytical layers

- ANALYSIS: Open unemployment can coexist with underemployment, low earnings and low productivity.
- ANALYSIS: Periodic labour-force estimates differ by reference period, status measure and rural-urban context.
- ANALYSIS: Labour regulation affects firm scale, bargaining, security, compliance and dispute resolution simultaneously.
- ANALYSIS: Skill policy must be employer-linked, outcome-measured and combined with foundational learning.
- ANALYSIS: Care infrastructure, safe transport and flexible work can raise women's participation without reducing protection.
- ANALYSIS: Portable social security is crucial for migrant, gig and platform workers whose employer relationships are fragmented.

4. Institutional architecture

- FACT: **Ministry of Labour and Employment:** administers central labour policy, employment services and social-security institutions.
- FACT: **State labour departments:** frame state rules where required and enforce workplace provisions.
- FACT: **EPFO, ESIC and e-Shram architecture:** provide or support formal and portable social protection.
- FACT: **Skill-development ministries, Sector Skill Councils and employers:** connect training with occupational demand and apprenticeships.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- ANALYSIS: A lower unemployment rate can reflect discouraged workers leaving the labour force rather than stronger job creation.
- ANALYSIS: A training certificate has limited value if employers do not recognise the competency or wages do not improve.
- ANALYSIS: A platform worker may enjoy flexible entry while remaining exposed to opaque ratings, variable demand and fragmented social security.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: Hiring flexibility may encourage formal jobs but weak safeguards shift risk to workers.
- ANALYSIS: High statutory protection helps insiders while weak enforcement leaves informal workers uncovered.
- ANALYSIS: Training supply is visible, but placement quality and wage progression are harder outcomes.
- ANALYSIS: Automation raises productivity while changing task composition and transition needs.
- ANALYSIS: Gig flexibility creates entry opportunities but algorithmic control can resemble employment dependence.

ANALYSIS: **Boundary condition:** Final Central Rules notified in May 2026 do not erase differences in state rules, inspection capacity and enforcement readiness.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: A person outside the labour force is not counted as unemployed.
- FACT: Employment quantity, productivity, earnings, security and working conditions are distinct.
- FACT: The four Labour Codes consolidate 29 central labour laws.
- FACT: The Codes cover wages, industrial relations, social security, and occupational safety, health and working conditions.
- FACT: Labour is in the Concurrent List, so implementation requires Centre-state legal and administrative readiness.
- FACT: Gig and platform work can expand flexibility while creating social-security and bargaining challenges.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: A falling unemployment rate always means more jobs. -> People leaving the labour force can also lower the rate.
- WRONG: Demographic dividend is automatic. -> It requires health, education, skills, jobs and female participation.
- WRONG: All informal workers are self-employed. -> Informality cuts across employment statuses.
- WRONG: Labour Codes were only passed but not in force. -> They came into force on 21 Nov 2025.
- WRONG: Central Rules alone guarantee uniform implementation. -> State rules and enforcement readiness may vary.

9. CURRENT: Survey 2025-26 analytical application

Verified current anchor	Topic-specific analytical use
CURRENT: The four Labour Codes came into force on 21 Nov 2025; final Central Rules were notified in May 2026.	Update older Labour-Code answers with commencement, Central Rules and uneven state implementation readiness.
CURRENT: Q2 FY26 had 56.2 crore employed persons aged 15 years and above.	An employment level is not a complete jobs assessment without participation, hours, earnings and productivity.
CURRENT: Female LFPR rose from 23.3% in 2017-18 to 41.7% in 2023-24. NITI Aayog reported about 77 lakh gig workers for 2020-21 and projected a later 2029-30 level; do not interpolate an official FY25 count.	Use the female-participation and gig-work trends to discuss care, mobility, flexibility and portable protection.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III asked merits, demerits and progress of the four Labour Codes.
- ANALYSIS: Current answer update: in force from 21 Nov 2025; final Central Rules notified in May 2026.
- ANALYSIS: **Answer engine:** benefits-consolidation, wage coverage, portable protection and compliance clarity; tensions-flexibility versus security, thresholds and bargaining, state capacity, platform-worker implementation and enforcement; assess outcomes rather than enactment alone.

Source: Ministry of Labour and Employment annual report 2025-26.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: Convert demographic potential into a dividend through participation, job creation, productivity, earnings and portable protection-not skill supply alone.

1. Define **LFPR** and distinguish it from **Worker-population ratio**.
2. Care responsibilities, safety, mobility and social norms shape labour-force participation, especially for women.

3. Ministry of Labour and Employment: administers central labour policy, employment services and social-security institutions.
4. Hiring flexibility may encourage formal jobs but weak safeguards shift risk to workers.
5. Convert demography into dividend through women-centred, apprenticeship-led and demand-linked policy.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims**: Distinguish LFPR, worker-population ratio and unemployment rate and identify the four Labour Codes.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks)**: Why can rapid economic growth coexist with weak employment quality?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks)**: Evaluate the Labour Codes after their 21 Nov 2025 commencement, including state readiness and gig-worker protection.

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion:
../basic/22_Employment-Labour-Codes-Skills-and-Demographic-Dividend.md.
- FACT: 02_Growth-Development-HDI-IHDI-and-MPI.md - capability formation.
- FACT: 17_MSMEs-PLI-Semiconductors-and-Manufacturing-Strategy.md - labour-intensive and technical manufacturing demand.
- FACT: 24_Services-Digital-Economy-Fintech-and-Platform-Markets.md - platform work and algorithmic management.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2022	GS-II	16	Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Cross-cutting; the stem names both inflation and unemployment	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	GS-II	18	Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment	Analyse the linkages · 15 marks · 250 words	Social Justice Core route; Economy employment link retained	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Managing inflation and unemployment beyond welfare schemes
- Skill development programmes and links between skill education and employment

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Employment, Labour Codes, Skills and Demographic Dividend: RAPID CONCEPT, INSTITUTION AND STATUS MAP

1. **Employment-quality frame:** Employment must be assessed through quantity, hours, productivity, real earnings, security, working conditions and mobility; a headcount alone is not a quality-jobs verdict.
2. **LFPR denominator:** The labour-force participation rate is the labour force, employed plus unemployed seeking or available for work, as a share of the specified population.
3. **Worker-population ratio:** The worker-population ratio is employed persons as a share of the specified population and therefore has a different numerator from LFPR.
4. **Unemployment-rate denominator:** The unemployment rate is unemployed persons as a share of the labour force, not as a share of the total population; people outside the labour force are not unemployed.
5. **PLFS status and reference period:** PLFS estimates must name the status concept and reference period, such as usual status or current weekly status, because the same labour market can produce different measures.
6. **Unemployment typology:** Frictional, structural, cyclical, seasonal and disguised unemployment identify different mechanisms and cannot be diagnosed from one aggregate rate.
7. **Human-capital formation:** Human-capital formation builds productive capabilities through health, education, skills and experience; certification is only one possible signal of capability.
8. **Skill and placement boundary:** A completed training or certification count is not a placement, sustained job, wage gain or productivity outcome.
9. **PMKVY scope:** Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana supports skill training, assessment and certification under the Skill India architecture; current targets or placements require a dated official source.
10. **Apprenticeship mechanism:** Apprenticeships combine workplace learning with employer demand and can reduce skill mismatch, but registration or seat creation does not prove completion or employment.
11. **Demographic-dividend condition:** A favourable working-age structure creates only demographic potential; health, learning, participation, productive jobs and savings-investment transmission determine the dividend.
12. **Female participation and care:** Women's labour-force participation is shaped by unpaid care, safety, mobility, job location and norms, so aggregate participation cannot substitute for gender and rural-urban disaggregation.
13. **Care and monetised economy:** Unpaid care supports household and market production but generally lies outside the monetised national-accounts production boundary; economic value and GDP inclusion are different questions.
14. **Four Labour Codes:** The Code on Wages, 2019 and the three 2020 Codes on industrial relations, social security and occupational safety, health and working conditions consolidate 29 central labour laws.
15. **Enactment and commencement:** Enactment, notification of commencement, central rules, state rules and enforcement readiness are separate stages in labour-law implementation.
16. **Current Labour-Code status:** Official Ministry material retrieved through official-domain search records commencement from 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026; state rules and enforcement readiness still require jurisdiction-specific verification.
17. **Concurrent-List implementation:** Labour's Concurrent-List setting means central codification does not by itself produce uniform state rules, inspection capacity or enforcement outcomes.
18. **Gig and platform work:** Gig or platform work can offer entry and flexibility while creating risks around algorithmic control, bargaining power, income variability and portable social security.
19. **Fixed-term and casual work boundary:** Fixed-term employment, casual work, contract labour and platform work are distinct legal and economic relationships; coverage under wage or social-security rules must be tested provision by provision.
20. **Productivity and job creation:** Labour-productivity growth can raise incomes and competitiveness, but job outcomes depend on demand, sectoral composition, labour intensity, transition support and the distribution of productivity gains.

Employment, Labour Codes, Skills and Demographic Dividend: SCOPE, ELIGIBILITY, STOCK-FLOW AND IMPLEMENTATION TRAPS

- Do not use total population as the unemployment-rate denominator.
- Do not treat people outside the labour force as unemployed.
- Do not quote PLFS data without status, reference period, age group and geography.
- Do not infer job quality from an employment headcount.
- Do not equate skill certification with placement or wage progression.
- Do not describe the demographic dividend as automatic or permanent.
- Do not equate unpaid care's GDP exclusion with absence of economic value.
- Do not merge Labour-Code enactment, commencement, rules and enforcement.
- Do not assume Central Rules establish uniform state implementation.
- Do not infer an objective PYQ answer letter from the routed ledger.

Employment, Labour Codes, Skills and Demographic Dividend: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

DEFINE THE MEASURE OR INSTITUTION AND FIX ITS COVERAGE
-> STATE FORMULA, CROP, GEOGRAPHY, ELIGIBILITY OR LEGAL POWER
-> NAME THE PERIOD, ESTIMATE VINTAGE AND ISSUING BODY
-> SEPARATE ANNOUNCEMENT, IMPLEMENTATION, STOCK AND FLOW OUTCOMES
-> ADD ONE INDIA-SPECIFIC EVIDENCE UNIT AND ITS LIMIT
-> TEST DISTRIBUTION, OUTPUT, PRICE OR FINANCIAL-STABILITY EFFECTS
-> CONCLUDE WITH A GRADED VERDICT, NOT A TIMELESS NUMBER

Employment, Labour Codes, Skills and Demographic Dividend: LIVE-SOURCE, VINTAGE AND EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

Official Ministry search results support commencement on 21 November 2025 and final Central Rules in May 2026. Direct pages and the annual-report PDF returned HTTP 403, so no state-by-state rule count, employment value, scheme target or outlay was added.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Jobs quality dashboard

QUANTITY + HOURS
PRODUCTIVITY + REAL EARNINGS
SECURITY + CONDITIONS
MOBILITY + PROTECTION
MUST REMEMBER: Employment analysis separates labour force, workforce, unemployment,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Labour indicators matrix

LFPR = labour force / specified population
WPR = employed / specified population
UR = unemployed / labour force
DENOMINATOR must be named

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: PLFS reference-period clock

USUAL STATUS -> longer reference
CURRENT WEEKLY STATUS -> seven-day reference
AGE + RURAL/URBAN -> always state
ONE headline cannot replace disaggregation

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Unemployment mechanism tree

FRICTIONAL -> transition
STRUCTURAL -> mismatch
SEASONAL / CYCLICAL -> timing + demand
DISGUISED -> surplus labour

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Human-capital chain

HEALTH + FOUNDATION LEARNING
-> SKILL + EXPERIENCE
-> PRODUCTIVE MATCH
-> EARNINGS + ADAPTABILITY

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Certification-to-outcome ladder

ENROLLED
-> TRAINED
-> CERTIFIED
-> PLACED -> RETAINED -> WAGE GAIN
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Unemployment rate denominator is labour force, not population; labour-...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Demographic dividend converter

WORKING-AGE SHARE
x HEALTH + EDUCATION
x PARTICIPATION + JOBS
x PRODUCTIVITY -> DIVIDEND

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Care-economy constraint map

UNPAID CARE -> time constraint
CARE SERVICES -> participation support
GDP BOUNDARY -> not value judgement
3R -> recognise + reduce + redistribute

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Labour Codes map

WAGES 2019
INDUSTRIAL RELATIONS 2020
SOCIAL SECURITY 2020
OSHC 2020

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Implementation status rail

ENACTED 2019-20
-> COMMENCEMENT 21 NOV 2025
-> FINAL CENTRAL RULES MAY 2026
-> STATE RULES + ENFORCEMENT vary

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: New-work boundary

FIXED-TERM
CASUAL / CONTRACT
GIG / PLATFORM
TEST wages + security + bargaining separately

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Employment answer spine

DEFINE indicator + denominator
DIAGNOSE unemployment type
LINK skills to demand
CONCLUDE jobs + earnings + portable protection
EVIDENCE LIMIT: FORMULA / STATUS / CAUSATION: Name PLFS status, reference period,...